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DANG: Prototype-Anchored Frozen DINOv3 Features for Generalizable Polyp Segmentation

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ABSTRACT Polyp segmentation networks score well on the colonoscopy centres they are trained on but lose accuracy on frames from other centres and devices. We present DANG, a segmentation network built on a frozen DINOv3 ViT-S/16 foundation model with convolutional low-rank adapters. DANG reads tokens from four depths of the frozen encoder, arranges them into a four-scale pyramid decoded by a scale-aware decoder, and adds a dual-prototype margin head that scores every token against learned foreground and background prototypes and image-specific self-support centroids. Of its 23.5M parameters only 1.9M are trained. We train on the standard 1,450-image Kvasir-SEG and CVC-ClinicDB split and test on the five standard test sets, on 1,399 deduplicated frames from the six centres of PolypGen and, as a held-out final test, on 1,376 frames of PolypDB. PraNet, Polyp-PVT, PraNet-V2 and SegDINO are retrained from their official code with the settings of their papers, every model is evaluated at its final epoch with one evaluator, and all results are means over five seeds with paired tests. On the three cohorts our claims rest on, DANG reaches 80.7, 82.7 and 84.2% mean Dice on CVC-ColonDB, ETIS-LaribPolypDB and PolypGen, against 80.9, 75.5 and 81.4% for the best retrained model on each: a tie on CVC-ColonDB and gains of 7.3 and 2.7 points that are significant against every compared model after Holm correction. On the in-domain CVC-ClinicDB test set it trails Polyp-PVT by 3.2 points. A batch-1 frame takes 9.1 ms on an NVIDIA T4 with CUDA graphs.

INDEX TERMS Colonoscopy, deep learning, domain generalization, foundation models, medical image segmentation, parameter-efficient fine-tuning, polyp segmentation, prototype learning.

I. INTRODUCTION

COLORECTAL cancer is the third most common cancer and the second leading cause of cancer death worldwide [1], and removing adenomatous polyps during colonoscopy lowers colorectal-cancer mortality [2]. Pixel-level polyp segmentation supports this by delineating lesion margins. The standard benchmark trains on 1,450 frames from two centres, Kvasir-SEG [3] and CVC-ClinicDB, and tests on five public sets [4]. On the two in-domain test sets current models exceed 90% mean Dice; on CVC-ColonDB [5] and ETIS-LaribPolypDB [6], which come from other centres and cameras, the same models lose 10–25 points (Table 2). Generalization to unseen centres, not in-domain accuracy, is the open problem.

Vision foundation models such as DINOv2 [7] and DINOv3 [8] are trained on very large image collections and transfer across domains, which makes them natural encoders for this problem. Keeping such an encoder frozen also keeps training cheap and the trainable part small. SegDINO [9] pairs a frozen DINOv3 with a light decoder. Under our protocol, however, it reaches only 43.2% mean Dice on ETIS (Table 2). How the frozen features are adapted and decoded therefore decides whether a frozen foundation model helps.

We present **DANG** (Figure 1) and make three contributions:

- **A frozen-foundation-model segmenter with a prototype margin head.** DANG adapts a frozen DINOv3 ViT-S/16 with convolutional low-rank adapters, decodes a token pyramid with a scale-aware decoder, and adds a dual-prototype margin head with test-time self-support. It trains 1.9M of its 23.5M parameters and needs no convolutional backbone.
- **A controlled benchmark.** The standard training split; the five standard test sets kept as published; two deduplicated multi-centre cohorts, PolypGen [10] and PolypDB [11], the latter held out as a final test; four published models retrained from their official code; final-epoch checkpoints, one evaluator, five seeds and paired

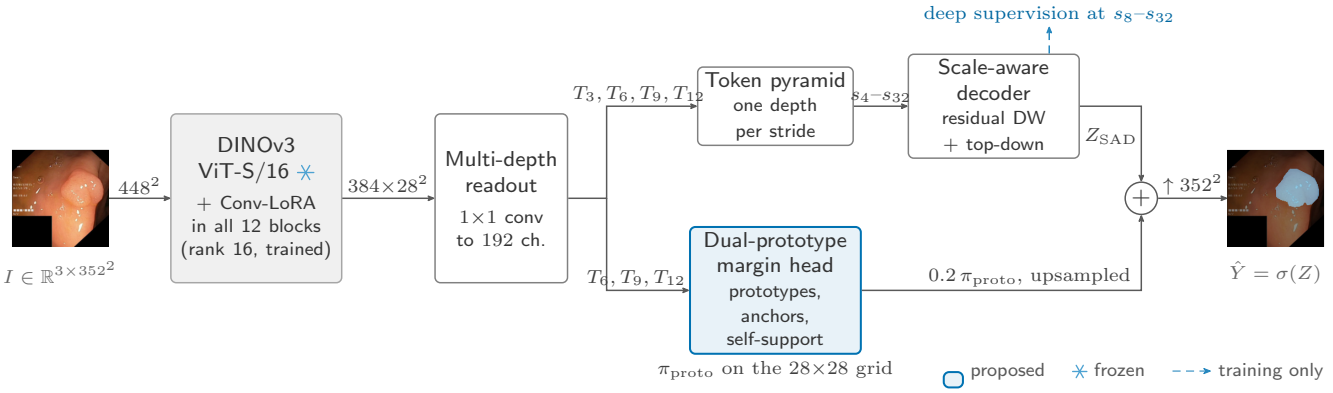


FIGURE 1. DANG decodes a frozen DINOv3 encoder through a token pyramid and a prototype margin head. A 352 × 352 frame is resized to 448 × 448 and encoded by a frozen DINOv3 ViT-S/16 whose 12 blocks carry trained Conv-LoRA adapters. Tokens from blocks 3, 6, 9 and 12 are projected to 192 channels on the 28 × 28 grid. The token pyramid assigns one depth to each stride (s_4–s_{32}) and the scale-aware decoder fuses them top-down into the logit Z_{SAD}. The dual-prototype margin head (the proposed component, blue) turns the three deepest maps into the margin map π_{proto}, which is added to Z_{SAD} with weight 0.2. Dashed: heads used only for deep supervision during training. Thumbnails: a Kvasir test frame and its ground-truth mask, for illustration only.

tests with multiplicity correction.

- **An ablation of the decoding path.** We compare a dual-stream design with a fine-tuned CNN, the token-pyramid trunk alone, a prototype-anchored support envelope, and three decoders, and report what each costs in latency on an NVIDIA T4.

II. RELATED WORK

a: Polyp segmentation.

Architectures progressed from U-Net [12] and UNet++ [13] to reverse-attention networks: PraNet [4] mines boundary cues with parallel partial decoders and reverse attention, and CaraNet [14] adds axial context for small objects. Transformer encoders improved multi-centre generalization in Polyp-PVT [15] and TransFuse [16], and EMCAD [17] pairs a PVTv2 encoder with an efficient multi-scale convolutional attention decoder. Recent models refine the decoder further: PraNet-V2 [18] supervises the background explicitly inside reverse attention, ASGNet [19] guides ResNet or PVTv2 features with an adaptive spectral filter, and CSG-Mamba [20] adds convolutional gating to a vision state-space U-Net. Their reported gains are hard to compare: an audit of 27 polyp segmentation papers [21] found at least five incompatible train/test splits of the same datasets, and 26 of the papers reported no significance test. Label-efficient work on polyps has mostly been semi-supervised; FPGM [22], for example, uses a frequency prior on polyp edges to augment unlabelled images and improve generalization to new centres.

b: Foundation models for polyps.

SAM applied without prompts segments polyps poorly [23], and MedSAM [24] fine-tunes SAM on a large medical corpus but requires box prompts. SAM 3 is being adapted in the same way: Medical SAM3 [25] fully fine-tunes it on 33 medical datasets, SAM3-Adapter [26] trains lightweight adapters, and HAT-SAM3 [27] adapts it to colonoscopy with a highlight-aware boundary regulariser. SAM-Mamba [28] and SAM-MaGuP [29] adapt SAM with Mamba-based priors for zero-shot polyp generalization, at about 103M parameters and 423 GFLOPs [30]. A second line distils foundation models into small networks: Polyp-DiFoM [31], LiteBounD [30] and Lite-π [32]. Closest to DANG, SegDINO [9] keeps a DINOv3 encoder [8] frozen and decodes multi-depth tokens with a light head, and its extended version [33] arranges the tokens into a multi-scale pyramid with a scale-aware decoder. DANG builds on this pyramid and decoder, adds trained adapters and a prototype margin head, and keeps the foundation model at inference without distillation.

c: Prototype-based segmentation.

Few-shot semantic segmentation classifies query pixels by their similarity to class prototypes computed from support images [34]. Self-support prototypes [35] are built from confident features of the query image itself, which narrows the gap between support and query appearance. DANG adopts this self-support idea inside a fully supervised segmenter: learned prototypes and ground-truth anchors give a prior, and image-specific self-support centroids adapt it at test time.

d: Adapting frozen vision transformers.

Low-rank adaptation (LoRA [36]) and its convolutional variant for SAM (Conv-LoRA [37]) adapt frozen transformers with few parameters, and dense-prediction heads such as DPT [38] reassemble ViT tokens from several depths into a multi-scale map. DANG uses Conv-LoRA adapters in every block of the frozen encoder and a fixed depth-to-stride assignment instead of learned reassembly.

III. METHOD

DANG maps an RGB frame $I \in \mathbb{R}^{3\times352\times352}$ to a polyp probability map $\hat{Y} = \sigma(Z)$ (Figure 1). We write $X^{\uparrow n}$ for bilinear resizing of a map X to $n\times n$ and s_k for stride k relative to the 352×352 input.

A. FROZEN ENCODER WITH CONVOLUTIONAL ADAPTERS

The encoder is DINOv3 ViT-S/16 [8], kept frozen. The frame is resized to 448×448 so that the 16-pixel patches form a 28×28 grid of 384-dimensional tokens. Each of the 12 blocks is followed by a Conv-LoRA adapter [37] of rank $r = 16$ that acts on the block output x:

$$x \leftarrow x + W_{\uparrow}\,\mathrm{GELU}\big(z + \mathcal{K}_{3\times3}(z)\big), \qquad z = W_{\downarrow}x, \tag{1}$$

where $W_{\downarrow} \in \mathbb{R}^{r\times384}$ and $W_{\uparrow} \in \mathbb{R}^{384\times r}$ are trained, $W_{\uparrow}$ is initialised to zero so that training starts from the frozen encoder, and $\mathcal{K}_{3\times3}$ is a depthwise convolution applied to the patch tokens on the 28×28 grid. The adapters add 0.15M parameters. We read the normalised patch tokens after blocks 3, 6, 9 and 12 and project each with a 1×1 convolution, batch normalisation and activation to a map $T_\ell \in \mathbb{R}^{192\times28\times28}$, $\ell \in \{3, 6, 9, 12\}$.

B. TOKEN PYRAMID AND SCALE-AWARE DECODER

Following the token pyramid of the extended SegDINO [33], each depth is assigned to one stride, shallow depths to fine strides:

$$\begin{aligned} P_4 &= \phi_4\big(\mathcal{U}(T_3^{\uparrow44})\big), \quad & P_8 &= \phi_8\big(T_6^{\uparrow44}\big),\\ P_{16} &= \phi_{16}\big(T_9^{\uparrow22}\big), & P_{32} &= \phi_{32}\big(\mathcal{D}(T_{12}^{\uparrow22})\big), \end{aligned} \tag{2}$$

where $\mathcal{U}$ is a learned depthwise $2\times$ transposed convolution, $\mathcal{D}$ a depthwise convolution with stride 2, and ϕ_s light convolution blocks (separable 3×3 at s_4 and s_8, 1×1 at s_{16} and s_{32}). The pyramid has no convolutional backbone: all four levels come from the frozen encoder.

The scale-aware decoder of [33] refines each level with a residual depthwise block

$$R(x) = x + \gamma\,\mathrm{GELU}\big(\mathrm{GN}(W_{1\times1}\,\mathcal{K}_{3\times3}(x))\big), \tag{3}$$

with a learned scalar γ initialised to zero and group normalisation GN, and then fuses the levels top-down,

$$\begin{aligned} X_{32} &= R'_{32}\big(R_{32}(P_{32})\big),\\ X_k &= R'_k\big(X_{2k}^{\uparrow} + R_k(P_k)\big), \quad k = 16, 8, 4, \end{aligned} \tag{4}$$

where R_k and R'_k are separate blocks of the form of Eq. (3). A 1×1 convolution on X_4 gives the decoder logit Z_{SAD} at s_4 (88×88). For deep supervision during training, 1×1 heads on X_8, X_{16} and X_{32} give auxiliary logits A_8, A_{16} and A_{32}; they are not used at inference.

C. DUAL-PROTOTYPE MARGIN HEAD

The head concatenates the three deepest maps T_6, T_9 and T_{12}, projects them with a 3×3 convolution block and a 1×1 convolution to 128 channels, and normalises each position to a unit embedding $e_{u,v}$ on the 28×28 grid. It compares $e_{u,v}$ with $K = 8$ learned foreground prototypes p_k^+ and $K = 8$ background prototypes p_k^- (unit vectors, orthogonally initialised), and with a foreground anchor a^+ and background anchor a^-:

$$\begin{aligned} \pi_{\mathrm{prior}}(u,v) = \tfrac{\tau}{\beta}\Big(&\log\textstyle\sum_k e^{\beta\langle e_{u,v},p_k^+\rangle} - \log\sum_k e^{\beta\langle e_{u,v},p_k^-\rangle}\Big)\\ &+ w_{\mathrm{a}}\big(\langle e_{u,v},a^+\rangle - \langle e_{u,v},a^-\rangle\big) + b. \end{aligned} \tag{5}$$

The log-sum-exp with fixed sharpness β is a soft maximum over prototypes; the temperature τ, the bias b and the bounded anchor weight w_{a} are learned. During training only, $a^{\pm}$ are exponential moving averages of the embeddings at positions where the ground-truth mask, average-pooled to 28×28, is mostly foreground or mostly background. At training and test time the head then forms image-specific self-support centroids [35] weighted by the prior's own confidence, $c^+ = \mathrm{Norm}(\sum_{u,v} q_{u,v}^2 e_{u,v})$ and $c^- = \mathrm{Norm}(\sum_{u,v}(1-q_{u,v})^2 e_{u,v})$ with $q = \sigma(\pi_{\mathrm{prior}})$, and outputs the margin map

$$\pi_{\mathrm{proto}} = \pi_{\mathrm{prior}} + w_{\mathrm{ss}}\big(\langle e,c^+\rangle - \langle e,c^-\rangle\big), \tag{6}$$

with a learned bounded weight w_{ss}. The final logit is

$$Z = \big(Z_{\mathrm{SAD}} + 0.2\,\pi_{\mathrm{proto}}^{\uparrow88}\big)^{\uparrow352}. \tag{7}$$

The prototype margin thus enters the output as a coarse, token-level prior on top of the decoder logit. Constant values are listed in Appendix A.

D. TRAINING OBJECTIVE

DANG is trained with

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{L} = {}& \mathcal{L}^w_{\mathrm{BCE+Dice}}(Z,Y) + 0.25\,\mathcal{L}^w_{\mathrm{Tv}}(Z,Y) + 0.1\,\mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{far}}(Z,Y)\\ &+ \tfrac{0.25}{3}\textstyle\sum_{k\in\{8,16,32\}}\mathcal{L}^w_{\mathrm{BCE+Dice}}(A_k^{\uparrow352},Y) + 0.35\,\mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{proto}}. \end{aligned} \tag{8}$$

Each image's terms are weighted by w, which grows as lesion area shrinks. The Tversky term $\mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{Tv}}$ penalises false negatives more for small lesions. $\mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{far}}$ is the mean predicted probability outside dilations of the ground truth. $\mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{proto}}$ applies the cross-entropy, Dice and Tversky terms to π_{proto} against the mask average-pooled to 28×28. Exact forms are in Appendix A. During training, each image's amplitude spectrum is mixed with that of another image in the batch with probability 0.5, keeping its phase (Fourier amplitude mix [39]), to vary colour and illumination statistics.

IV. EXPERIMENTAL SETUP

A. DATA

We use the standard split [4]: 900 Kvasir-SEG and 550 CVC-ClinicDB images for training, and the five standard test sets kept exactly as published (Table 1). Because these test sets are small, we add two multi-centre cohorts. From PolypGen [10] we keep 1,399 of 1,536 frames from its six centres, after dropping 125 frames with empty masks and 12 within-set duplicates. From PolypDB [11] we keep 1,376 frames of six centre and modality groups (white light, BLI, FICE, LCI and NBI); we drop its Norwegian white-light group, which comes from the hospital that collected Kvasir-SEG. Every kept frame is compared against all 1,450 training images and the frames already kept from its own set. Two frames count as duplicates when their MD5 hashes match, or when the Pearson correlation of their 32×32 grey-scale thumbnails, taken after cropping the dark endoscope border, is at least 0.97 and their masks overlap with IoU at least 0.8. A 64-bit difference hash was tried first and rejected because the

TABLE 1. Cohorts. The five standard test sets are kept as published; PolypGen and PolypDB are deduplicated against the training images. Primary: the cohorts our claims rest on. PolypDB is the held-out final test.

Cohort	Source	Images	Role
Train	Kvasir-SEG + CVC-ClinicDB	1,450	training
Kvasir	Kvasir-SEG [3]	100	in domain
ClinicDB	CVC-ClinicDB	62	in domain
ColonDB	CVC-ColonDB [5]	380	primary
ETIS	ETIS-LaribPolypDB [6]	196	primary
CVC-300	EndoScene test [4]	60	reported
PolypGen	PolypGen, 6 centres [10]	1,399	primary
PolypDB	PolypDB, 6 groups [11]	1,376	final test

black border dominates it on endoscopy frames. The highest thumbnail correlation of a kept frame with any training image is 0.94 for PolypGen and 0.92 for PolypDB.

We base our claims on CVC-ColonDB, ETIS and PolypGen, the three cohorts that are both external to the training centres and large enough for per-image statistics. Kvasir and ClinicDB share their training centres, and ClinicDB and CVC-300 are so small that one image moves mean Dice by 1.6 and 1.7 points; we report them for comparability.

B. MODELS AND TRAINING

DANG is trained for 20 epochs at 352×352 with batch size 16, AdamW, linear warm-up and cosine decay, gradient clipping, mixed precision and an exponential moving average of the weights; all hyperparameters are listed in Table 7. There is no validation split and no checkpoint selection: we evaluate the moving-average weights after the last epoch.

Published scores rest on incompatible splits and are rarely tested for significance [21], and the released training scripts of some models select checkpoints on test data. We therefore retrain the compared models instead of copying their numbers. PraNet [4], Polyp-PVT [15] and PraNet-V2 [18] are retrained from their official code with the training settings of their papers and released scripts, and SegDINO [9] with those of its paper; SegDINO uses the same frozen DINOv3 ViT-S/16 encoder as DANG. Every model is evaluated at its final epoch.

C. METRICS AND STATISTICS

All models are scored by one evaluator. Probabilities are resized bilinearly to the native ground-truth resolution and thresholded at 0.5; Dice is computed per image and averaged over the images of a cohort (for PolypGen and PolypDB, over all frames of all centres). For comparison with published tables we also report the toolbox mean Dice, the Dice averaged over 256 thresholds of the min-max-normalised probability map, which is the metric of the evaluation scripts behind PraNet, Polyp-PVT and PraNet-V2.

Five seeds (42–46) are run for every model. We test DANG against each compared model in two ways. At the seed level, a two-sided paired t-test compares the per-seed mean Dice of matched seeds ($n = 5$). At the image level, a two-sided Wilcoxon signed-rank test [40] compares per-image Dice averaged over the five seeds. For each compared model, Holm's procedure [41] corrects each test over the three primary cohorts.

Inference cost is measured for all models in one process on one NVIDIA T4 at batch size 1 and 352×352 input: the median of 300 timed forward passes after 50 warm-up passes, in FP16 autocast (eager) and with FP16 weights replayed from a CUDA graph. We also report multiply-accumulate operations (MACs) per frame and total parameters, frozen weights included.

V. RESULTS

A. COMPARISON WITH RETRAINED PUBLISHED MODELS

Table 2 compares DANG with the four retrained models. Among them, Polyp-PVT is the strongest on ColonDB (80.9%) and PolypGen (81.4%), and PraNet-V2 on ETIS (75.5%). DANG reaches 80.7% on ColonDB, 82.7% on ETIS and 84.2% on PolypGen. On ColonDB it ties Polyp-PVT (-0.2 points); on ETIS and PolypGen it is 7.3 and 2.7 points above the best retrained model, with the smallest seed-to-seed SD of all models on the three primary cohorts (0.2–0.7 points). On Kvasir it is the best model (92.2%, $+1.2$ points), while on ClinicDB (89.7%) it is 3.2 points below Polyp-PVT and on CVC-300 (88.8%) 1.0 point below PraNet. ClinicDB is one of the two training centres, so the models with fully fine-tuned encoders may fit it more closely; with 62 images, one image is worth 1.6 points, so the gap amounts to two images.

SegDINO, which uses the same frozen encoder with a light decoder, stays far below every other model, at 51.5% on ColonDB and 43.2% on ETIS. It is trained at the 256×256 input of its paper and without adapters, so this gap mixes input resolution and adaptation; Section V-B isolates the decoding choices at a fixed resolution.

a: Statistical tests.

Table 3 gives the paired tests on the primary cohorts. On ETIS and PolypGen, DANG is better than every retrained model at the seed and the image level after Holm correction; against Polyp-PVT the seed-level adjusted p-values are 0.007 and 0.031, and DANG is better on 123 of 196 ETIS images (worse on 70) and on 746 of 1,399 PolypGen frames (worse on 647). On ColonDB, DANG is better than PraNet, PraNet-V2 and SegDINO, and statistically indistinguishable from Polyp-PVT at both levels (adjusted $p = 0.72$ and 0.99; 187 images better, 191 worse).

b: Link to published numbers.

Table 4 reports the toolbox metric next to published scores. Our Polyp-PVT is within 1.2 points of its published scores on Kvasir, ClinicDB and ColonDB, and 2.2 and 4.3 points below them on CVC-300 and ETIS. ETIS has the largest seed-to-seed spread of the five sets, and part of the published advantage may come from selecting the checkpoint on test data. Our PraNet is 0.3 points below its published score on Kvasir and above it on the other four sets. Under this metric DANG leads

TABLE 2. Comparison with retrained published models. Dice (%) at threshold 0.5, mean ± SD over 5 seeds, final-epoch weights, one evaluator. ColonDB, ETIS and PolypGen are the primary cohorts; PolypDB is the held-out final test, run once for the selected model. Bold: best in column. *: worse than DANG after Holm correction (seed-level paired *t*-test, Section IV-C). Params: total parameters in millions, frozen weights included; Trained: parameters updated in training. –: not run (PolypDB is evaluated once, on the final model).

			In domain		Primary (external)			External	Final test
Model	Params	Trained	Kvasir	ClinicDB	ColonDB	ETIS	PolypGen	CVC-300	PolypDB
PraNet [4]	32.5	32.5	$90.0_{\pm 0.8}$	$90.9_{\pm 1.1}$	$72.0_{\pm 2.4}$*	$65.0_{\pm 2.2}$*	$79.0_{\pm 0.7}$*	$\mathbf{89.8}_{\pm 0.6}$	$84.8_{\pm 0.7}$
Polyp-PVT [15]	25.1	25.1	$91.0_{\pm 0.7}$	$\mathbf{92.9}_{\pm 0.7}$	$\mathbf{80.9}_{\pm 0.8}$	$74.7_{\pm 2.4}$*	$81.4_{\pm 1.3}$*	$88.2_{\pm 1.0}$	$\mathbf{86.7}_{\pm 1.3}$
PraNet-V2 [18]	30.8	30.8	$90.7_{\pm 0.7}$	$91.9_{\pm 1.2}$	$76.2_{\pm 1.6}$*	$75.5_{\pm 0.9}$*	$80.7_{\pm 0.7}$*	$88.4_{\pm 1.3}$	$85.4_{\pm 1.4}$
SegDINO [9]	24.1	2.48	$81.6_{\pm 0.9}$	$74.1_{\pm 2.1}$	$51.5_{\pm 4.6}$*	$43.2_{\pm 2.9}$*	$64.2_{\pm 1.1}$*	$70.5_{\pm 1.1}$	$72.4_{\pm 0.7}$
DANG (ours)	23.5	1.94	$\mathbf{92.2}_{\pm 0.4}$	$89.7_{\pm 1.3}$	$80.7_{\pm 0.3}$	$\mathbf{82.7}_{\pm 0.7}$	$\mathbf{84.2}_{\pm 0.2}$	$88.8_{\pm 1.9}$	–

TABLE 3. Paired tests of DANG against each retrained model on the primary cohorts. Δ: mean Dice difference (pp, DANG minus model) over 5 matched seeds; p_{seed}: paired *t*-test over seeds; p_{img}: Wilcoxon signed-rank test over images on seed-averaged Dice, with the number of images on which DANG is better/worse. All *p*-values Holm-corrected over the three cohorts.

	ColonDB ($n = 380$)			**ETIS** ($n = 196$)			**PolypGen** ($n = 1{,}399$)		
	Δ	p_{seed}	p_{img}	Δ	p_{seed}	p_{img}	Δ	p_{seed}	p_{img}
PraNet	+8.8	0.001	<0.001 (255/122)	+17.8	<0.001	<0.001 (140/51)	+5.2	<0.001	<0.001 (844/548)
Polyp-PVT	−0.2	0.715	0.989 (187/191)	+8.1	0.007	<0.001 (123/70)	+2.7	0.031	<0.001 (746/647)
PraNet-V2	+4.5	0.004	<0.001 (233/144)	+7.3	<0.001	<0.001 (123/70)	+3.4	<0.001	<0.001 (765/630)
SegDINO	+29.2	<0.001	<0.001 (365/12)	+39.5	<0.001	<0.001 (187/4)	+19.9	<0.001	<0.001 (1301/93)

TABLE 4. Toolbox mean Dice on the standard test sets (%), the metric of published polyp tables. Published rows are copied from the papers; ‡: the released training script selects its checkpoint on test data. Our rows: mean ± SD over 5 seeds, final-epoch weights. Bold: best of our rows.

Model	Kvasir	ClinicDB	ColonDB	ETIS	CVC-300
PraNet (published) [4]	89.8	89.9	70.9	62.8	87.1
Polyp-PVT (published)‡ [15]	91.7	93.7	80.8	78.7	90.0
PraNet [4]	$89.5_{\pm 0.7}$	$90.5_{\pm 1.1}$	$72.1_{\pm 2.3}$	$65.8_{\pm 2.0}$	$\mathbf{89.2}_{\pm 0.6}$
Polyp-PVT [15]	$\mathbf{90.7}_{\pm 0.7}$	$\mathbf{92.5}_{\pm 0.7}$	$\mathbf{80.6}_{\pm 0.8}$	$74.4_{\pm 2.4}$	$87.8_{\pm 1.0}$
PraNet-V2 [18]	$90.4_{\pm 0.7}$	$91.5_{\pm 1.2}$	$75.9_{\pm 1.6}$	$75.2_{\pm 0.9}$	$88.1_{\pm 1.3}$
SegDINO [9]	$77.9_{\pm 0.9}$	$70.9_{\pm 1.2}$	$51.8_{\pm 2.7}$	$44.2_{\pm 1.4}$	$65.6_{\pm 0.5}$
DANG (ours)	$90.7_{\pm 0.4}$	$88.4_{\pm 1.1}$	$79.4_{\pm 0.3}$	$\mathbf{81.0}_{\pm 0.6}$	$87.8_{\pm 1.8}$

on ETIS (81.0%, also above the published 78.7% of Polyp-PVT), ties Polyp-PVT on Kvasir and CVC-300, and ranks below it on ClinicDB and ColonDB (79.4 against 80.6%).

B. WHAT THE DECODING PATH CONTRIBUTES

Table 5 traces the design from a dual-stream model to DANG. All rows use the same frozen DINOv3 ViT-S/16 with Conv-LoRA adapters, the same loss family, recipe and evaluator, and the same T4 hardware; the upper block is a single seed and the lower block five seeds. In the upper block, differences should be read against the seed-to-seed SD of PraNet, Polyp-PVT and PraNet-V2 on the primary cohorts, 0.7–2.4 points (Table 2).

a: The convolutional stream is not needed.

Replacing the fine-tuned ConvNeXt-Tiny [42] local stream by the token pyramid halves the parameters (54.2M to 25.0M) and changes primary-cohort Dice by +2.1 (ColonDB), +0.9 (ETIS) and −0.7 (PolypGen) points at seed 42. The frozen encoder therefore supplies the fine-stride features the decoder needs.

b: The support envelope.

Removing PASSE from the token-pyramid model changes the primary cohorts by −1.6, −0.5 and −0.5 points at seed 42, within single-seed noise; we drop it from DANG. This variant has a single seed, so the five-seed advantage of the fg/bg decoder with PASSE reported below cannot be split between the decoder and the envelope.

c: The decoder.

With the same token pyramid, the scale-aware decoder and the fg/bg query decoder replace the four fg/bg stages and the 768-channel head. At seed 42 and compared with the fg/bg decoder without PASSE, the scale-aware decoder (DANG) changes the primary cohorts by +0.1, +0.7 and −0.1 points with 1.5M fewer parameters. Over five seeds the fg/bg decoder with PASSE is the most accurate variant: it is 1.0, 0.4 and 0.5 points above DANG on ColonDB, ETIS and PolypGen. The differences are small but consistent: they are not significant at the seed level after Holm correction (adjusted $p = 0.064$, 0.116 and 0.076), but they are at the image level ($p < 0.001$ on all three; on ColonDB it is better on 251 images and worse on 128). The query decoder lies between the two on ColonDB and PolypGen and below both on ETIS; none of its differences to DANG is significant at the seed level. We select the scale-aware decoder for its cost: against the fg/bg decoder with PASSE it removes 1.5M parameters and 30% of

TABLE 5. Decoding-path ablation. Dice (%) at threshold 0.5; all models use the frozen DINOv3 ViT-S/16 with Conv-LoRA adapters, the recipe of Section IV-B and T4 hardware. Upper block: seed 42; lower block: mean over 5 seeds. "fg/bg decoder": four top-down stages predicting foreground and background logits gated by boundary uncertainty, with a 768-channel fusion head; PASSE: prototype-anchored spatial support envelope on the output logits. Latency: batch 1, FP16 CUDA graph on an NVIDIA T4. Bold: best in column within a block. –: the query decoder could not be timed (the FLOP counter fails on its attention layers).

Variant	Params (M)	Latency (ms)	Kvasir	ClinicDB	ColonDB	ETIS	PolypGen	CVC-300
Seed 42								
Dual stream: ConvNeXt-T + ViT-S, fg/bg decoder, PASSE	54.2	15.3	**92.7**	**91.5**	80.2	82.3	**85.3**	88.2
Token pyramid only, fg/bg decoder, PASSE	25.0	11.2	92.4	90.4	**82.3**	**83.2**	84.7	**89.0**
without PASSE	25.0	11.1	91.8	91.4	80.7	82.7	84.2	89.0
Token pyramid, fg/bg query decoder	25.4	–	92.2	91.1	81.4	81.0	84.1	89.8
DANG: token pyramid, scale-aware decoder	23.5	9.1	92.4	90.0	80.8	83.4	84.2	90.9
Five seeds								
Token pyramid only, fg/bg decoder, PASSE	25.0	11.2	92.2	90.6	**81.7**	**83.1**	**84.6**	**89.2**
Token pyramid, fg/bg query decoder	25.4	–	**92.3**	**90.9**	81.3	82.3	84.4	88.8
DANG: token pyramid, scale-aware decoder	23.5	9.1	92.2	89.7	80.7	82.7	84.2	88.8

TABLE 6. Inference cost on one NVIDIA T4 at batch size 1 and 352 × 352 input, all models timed in one process. Params and Trained in millions; MACs per frame in billions; eager: FP16 autocast; graph: FP16 weights replayed from a CUDA graph; throughput at batch size 8, eager. –: not timed (SegDINO is not part of the timing harness).

				Latency (ms)		
Model	Params	Trained	GMACs	eager	graph	img/s
PraNet	32.5	32.5	13.0	20.7	8.3	180
Polyp-PVT	25.1	25.1	10.8	18.5	9.5	166
PraNet-V2	30.8	30.8	12.1	23.9	10.1	163
SegDINO	24.1	2.48	–	–	–	–
DANG (ours)	23.5	1.94	25.1	21.8	9.1	44

the MACs (25.1G against 36.1G) and cuts the T4 latency by 19% (9.1 ms against 11.2 ms), for a loss of at most 1.0 point on the primary cohorts. Where accuracy matters more than latency, the fg/bg decoder with PASSE is the better choice.

C. EFFICIENCY

Table 6 lists the cost of each model. DANG has the fewest total and trained parameters of all compared models, but about twice the MACs per frame (25.1G against 10.8–13.0G), because the frozen encoder runs at 448×448. With FP16 weights in a CUDA graph its batch-1 latency (9.1 ms, about 110 frames per second) lies between PraNet (8.3 ms) and Polyp-PVT (9.5 ms) and below PraNet-V2 (10.1 ms). In eager mode, where the encoder runs in FP32 as in training, it is the slowest at batch size 8 (44 against 163–180 images per second); batched offline processing would need the FP16 encoder.

VI. LIMITATIONS

1) **Adaptive design.** The standard split has no validation set, and the decoder variants were compared on the test cohorts, including the three primary ones. Kvasir, ClinicDB, ColonDB, ETIS, CVC-300 and PolypGen are therefore not fully held out for DANG. PolypDB was never used for design and is the held-out final test; it has not yet been run for DANG, so all DANG results in this paper come from cohorts that informed its design.
2) **Recipes differ.** The compared models use the recipes of their papers, DANG its own; in particular only DANG trains with Fourier amplitude mixing and mixed precision. The comparison is between methods as published, not a controlled ablation of the recipe.
3) **Hardware.** DANG and most compared models were trained on NVIDIA T4 GPUs; Polyp-PVT, whose 99-epoch schedule exceeds our T4 session limit, was trained on cloud GPUs of another type.
4) **Single-seed ablation.** Most rows of Table 5 are single seeds, and their differences are within seed-to-seed variation.
5) **One training split.** All models are trained on the same two centres; we do not test other training sources or label budgets.
6) **Scope.** We evaluate single frames, not video, and report no clinical reader study.

VII. CONCLUSION

DANG segments polyps from a frozen DINOv3 ViT-S/16 with convolutional adapters, a token pyramid, a scale-aware decoder and a dual-prototype margin head, training 1.9M of 23.5M parameters. Retrained under one protocol with five seeds, it ties Polyp-PVT on CVC-ColonDB and exceeds every compared model on ETIS-LaribPolypDB (+7.3 points) and PolypGen (+2.7 points), at a T4 latency of 9.1 ms, while it trails Polyp-PVT on the in-domain CVC-ClinicDB. The ablation shows that the frozen encoder alone supplies the multi-scale features, so a fine-tuned convolutional stream can be removed, and that a heavier fg/bg decoder with a support envelope buys up to 1 further point at 23% more latency. Next steps are the held-out PolypDB test, training on other centres, and evaluation on video.

TABLE 7. DANG hyperparameters. Lesion area a is the ground-truth foreground percentage of the image.

Item	Setting
Encoder	DINOv3 ViT-S/16 (LVD-1689M), frozen, input 448×448, run in FP32 (its attention logits overflow FP16 during training)
Adapters	Conv-LoRA, rank 16, after each of the 12 blocks; readout after blocks 3, 6, 9, 12; 192 decoder channels
Optimiser	AdamW; learning rate 10^{-3} (adapters), 4×10^{-4} (all other trained modules)
Weight decay	10^{-4}; none on adapters, normalisation, bias, gain and prototype parameters
Schedule	linear warm-up for 2 epochs, then cosine decay to 5%; 20 epochs; batch size 16
Weight averaging	EMA with decay $\min(0.992,\ (1+t)/(10+t))$ at step t; final EMA weights are evaluated
Other	gradient-norm clipping at 3.0; FP16 mixed precision on T4
Augmentation	scale 0.65–0.90 ($p = 0.3$) or 0.95–1.20 with crop or pad; horizontal and vertical flips ($p = 0.5$ each); 90° rotations ($p = 0.5$); brightness, contrast, saturation $\pm 15\%$ ($p = 0.4$); hue ± 0.04 ($p = 0.3$); gamma 0.8–1.25 ($p = 0.3$); Fourier amplitude mix with a random batch partner, $\lambda \sim U(0,1)$ ($p = 0.5$)
Image weight	$w = \mathrm{clip}\big((3/(a+0.35))^{0.4},\ 1,\ 2.4\big)$
Tversky	false-positive weight $0.45 + 0.15\,\sigma((a-1.5)/0.5)$, false-negative weight 1 minus it
Far-field loss	mean probability outside the ground truth dilated by 4, 8, 14 and 20 pixels
Prototype head	$K = 8 + 8$ prototypes, dimension 128; $\beta = 6$; τ learned, initialised at 12 and clamped to $[4, 25]$ $w_{\mathrm{a}} = 10 \cdot \frac{1}{2}\tanh(\theta_{\mathrm{a}})$, $w_{\mathrm{ss}} = 8 \cdot \frac{1}{2}\tanh(\theta_{\mathrm{ss}})$ with learned θ
Anchors	momentum 0.95; foreground where pooled mask ≥ 0.35, background where ≤ 0.10

APPENDIX A IMPLEMENTATION DETAILS DATA AND CODE AVAILABILITY

All experiments use public, de-identified datasets (Kvasir-SEG [3], CVC-ClinicDB, CVC-ColonDB [5], ETIS-LaribPolypDB [6], CVC-300, PolypGen [10] and PolypDB [11]) under their research licences; no new patient data were collected. Code, deduplication manifests, per-image evaluation logs and the scripts that regenerate every table from the raw logs will be released.

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